

【8.29| Economist】On shifting oil sands 论油砂之变局

难度评级: ★★★★★

【考研那些事儿之社论系列】

今日文章脉络：

引言：受油价上涨、国内政治阻力减弱影响，
加拿大石油行业迎来新一轮繁荣 (Para. 1)



产业基础与利好：加拿大油砂储量庞大，虽开采加工弊端显著，
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运输条件改善：加拿大输油管道项目落地投用，
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政策风向转变：加拿大政府为降低对美能源依赖，简化石油项目审批，
全力扶持石油基建与出海发展 (Para. 4)



行业发展阻碍：即便政策利好，
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发展受限根源：2014 年油价暴跌重创行业，
且油砂项目投资大、周期长、风险高，制约行业扩张 (Para. 6)



行业景气佐证：卡尔加里牛仔节的行业活动热度回升，
印证加拿大石油行业繁荣态势全面开启 (Para. 7)

Canada's oil industry is booming. Can it last? 加拿大石油产业正蓬勃发展。这种势头能否持续？

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

“Please god, give me one more oil **boom**—and I promise not to piss it all away next time” reads a popular **bumper** sticker in Canada's oil **patch**. Recent results from the country's oil producers show that **plea** has been answered. Oil prices have jumped as the **passage** of tankers through the Strait of Hormuz has been choked off. Last month Cenovus Energy reported that operating profits in its most recent quarter had nearly tripled compared with a year before. Canadian Natural Resources posted its best-ever quarterly adjusted operating profit. Moreover, the easing of political **headwinds** in Canada may improve the chances of the boom lasting.

- **boom n.** /bu:m/ A period of rapid economic growth or prosperity. (经济) 繁荣, 兴旺【考研大纲词汇】

The housing market is enjoying an unexpected boom.

房地产市场正迎来一场意外的繁荣。

SYN prosperity, surge

OPP slump, recession

- **bumper n.** / 'bʌmpər / Bumpers are bars at the front and back of a vehicle that protect it if it bumps into something. 保险杠

What stickers do you have on the bumper or the back windshield? 你在汽车保险杠或后挡风玻璃上用的是什么贴纸?

- **patch n.** /pætʃ/ A particular area of land known for a certain-industry. 地区, 地带【考研大纲词汇】

Farmers have settled in this remote wheat-growing patch. 农民们定居在这片偏远的小麦产区。

- **plea n.** /pli:/ An emotional request made to someone in power. 恳求, 请求【考研大纲词汇】

She made a plea for more funds to help homeless people. 她恳求拨付更多资金来救助无家可归者。

SYN appeal, request

- **passage n.** / 'pæsidʒ / A passage is a long narrow space with walls or fences on both sides, that connects one place or room with another. 过道; 走廊

Harry stepped into the passage and closed the door behind him. 哈里走进走廊, 关上他身后的门。

- **headwind n.** /'hedwind/ A force or difficulty that slows

progress. 阻力，不利因素【非考研大纲词汇】

Rising inflation has become a major headwind for business expansion. 不断上涨的通胀已经成为企业扩张的一大阻力。

SYN obstacle, barrier

加拿大产油区有一款热门车贴，上面写道：“求求上天，再赐我一场石油繁荣吧——我保证，下一次绝不挥霍一空。”加拿大石油厂商近期的业绩表明，这份祈愿已然应验。由于油轮在霍尔木兹海峡通行受阻，油价一路飙升。上月，森诺瓦斯能源（Cenovus Energy）公布了最近一个季度的营业利润——几乎增至去年同期的三倍；加拿大自然资源公司（Canadian Natural Resources）也公布了季度调整后营业利润——亦创下历史新高。此外，加拿大国内政治阻力有所缓和，可能会提高此轮繁荣持续的可能性。

【Para.2】

Canada has the world's fourth-largest proven reserves, with 97% found in the oil sands in a **remote** corner of the **land-locked** province of Alberta. Here the **bitumen**, mixed with sand and clay, is almost solid, and is **mined** rather than **tapped** from the ground. It is costly and dirty to extract and process. Despite the drawbacks, high prices combined with a weakening of the Canadian dollar mean that “it hasn't been this good to be

an oil-sands producer in a very long time,” says Andrew Leach of the University of Alberta.

- **remote adj.** /rɪ'məʊt/ Far away in distance from cities and populated areas. 偏远的，遥远的【考研大纲词汇】

Many wildlife species live in remote mountain valleys.

许多野生动物种栖息在偏远的山谷之中。

SYN isolated, distant

OPP accessible, nearby

- **land-locked adj.** /'ləndlɒkt/ Surrounded entirely by land, with no coastline. 内陆的，被陆地包围的【非考研大纲词汇】

Switzerland is a famous land-locked country in Europe.

瑞士是欧洲著名的内陆国家。

- **bitumen n.** /'bɪtʃəmən/ A sticky, black semi-solid form of petroleum. 沥青；原油沥青【非考研大纲词汇】

Bitumen is widely used to build roads. 沥青被广泛用于道路修建。

- **mine v.** /maɪn/ To dig deep into the earth in order to obtain minerals. 开采，采掘【考研大纲词汇】

Local workers mine copper from these mountains. 当地工人在这些山里开采铜矿。

- **tap v.** /tæp/ To draw liquid, gas or resources from a

source. 开采, 开发 (资源)【考研大纲词汇】

The company plans to tap underground geothermal energy. 这家公司计划开采地下地热资源。

加拿大已探明的石油储量位居全球第四，其中 97%蕴藏在内陆地区阿尔伯塔省一处偏远地带的油砂之中。这里的沥青混杂砂石与黏土，近乎固态，只能采用露天挖掘方式开采，无法通过钻井抽取。开采与加工油砂成本高昂，且污染较重。阿尔伯塔大学的安德鲁·利奇（Andrew Leach）表示，尽管存在上述弊端，但当前油价高涨，再加上加元贬值，意味着“很长一段时间以来，油砂生产商从未拥有过如此利好的环境”。

【Para.3】

Getting more oil to market is also set to become easier. Justin Trudeau, Canada's former prime minister, was **tepid** in his support for new pipelines, fearing the consequences for the climate. In 2018 regional political opposition led Kinder Morgan, an American firm, to suspend work on a **conduit** from Alberta to the west coast in British Columbia. That forced the national government to step in and complete it. Oil eventually started flowing in 2024.

- **tepid adj.** /'tepid/ Showing little enthusiasm; not warm.
不热情的，冷淡的【非考研大纲词汇】

Public reaction to the new policy remained tepid. 公众

对这项新政策反应冷淡。

SYN lukewarm, half-hearted

OPP enthusiastic, passionate

- **conduit** n. /'kɒndɪt/ A large pipe or channel for transporting liquid or gas. 管道，输油管【非考研大纲词汇】

The conduit carries natural gas across three provinces.

这条输气管道横跨三个省份输送天然气。

SYN pipeline, channel

扩大石油入市规模的难度将降低。加拿大前总理贾斯汀·特鲁多（Justin Trudeau）对新建输油管道项目的态度较为冷淡，担心对气候造成负面影响。2018 年，地方政界的反对迫使美国金德尔-摩根公司暂停修建一条从阿尔伯塔省通往不列颠哥伦比亚省西海岸的输油管道。随后，加拿大联邦政府不得不接手项目并完工。直到 2024 年，这条管道才正式输油。

【Para.4】

Lately the political mood has shifted. A trade war with America, the destination for 90% of Canadian oil, has shifted the federal government's focus to reducing dependence on its southern neighbour. That includes support for building new infrastructure to transport oil (and gas) to ports on Canada's west coast, from where it can be shipped to Asia. Mark Carney,

Canada's current prime minister, is **intent** on **slashing** the red tape that holds up projects, including streamlining environmental permitting and consultations with **indigenous** communities. The speedier process will apply to a new pipeline under development to British Columbia, announced last month. Lisa Baiton of the Canadian Association of Petroleum Producers, an industry group, has spoken of a “generational opportunity” to **rally** political and public support behind new oil projects.

- **intent adj.** /ɪn'tent/ Determined to achieve a particular goal. 决心做..... 的【考研大纲词汇】

The mayor is intent on reducing the city's pollution level. 市长下定决心降低本市的污染水平。

SYN determined, resolved

- **slash v.** /slæʃ/ To reduce something drastically and quickly. 大幅削减【考研大纲词汇】

The firm decided to slash its operating costs. 该公司决定大幅削减运营成本。

SYN cut, reduce sharply

- **indigenous adj.** /ɪn'dɪdʒənəs/ Originating or living naturally in a particular region. 本土的，土著的【考研大纲词汇】

These forests are home to several indigenous communities. 这片森林是多个土著部落的家园。

SYN native, aboriginal

OPP foreign, immigrant

- **rally v.** /'ræli/ To gather people together for a shared cause. 召集，团结，集结【考研大纲词汇】

Citizens rallied to support the environmental protection campaign. 民众团结起来支持这项环保运动。

近来国内政治风向已然转变。加拿大 90%的石油出口至美国，而加美贸易摩擦，促使联邦政府的重点转移到减少对其南部邻国的依赖上。为此，政府支持新建基础设施，将石油（以及天然气）输送至加拿大西海岸港口，再从那里运往亚洲市场。加拿大现任总理马克·卡尼（Mark Carney）决心削减阻碍项目发展的繁文缛节，具体措施包括精简环境许可审批流程，以及优化与原住民社区的磋商程序。上月公布的新建不列颠哥伦比亚省输油管道的项目，就将采用这套更快的审批流程。加拿大石油生产商协会（石油行业的组织）的莉萨·拜顿（Lisa Baiton）称，当前有一个“时代性的机遇”，能够凝聚政界与公众力量，赋能新的石油项目。

【Para.5】

The promise of a federal government more friendly to pipes may not be enough, however. Enbridge, an energy-infrastructure firm, has paused construction of a pipeline to the east, citing a lack of **commitments** by

producers to provide enough oil to make it worthwhile.

- **commitment** n. /kə'mɪtmənt/ A formal promise to do something. 承诺，许诺【考研大纲词汇】

The company made a commitment to cut carbon emissions. 这家公司作出了减排的承诺。

SYN pledge, promise

然而，仅靠联邦政府对输油管道项目作出友好承诺，或许远远不够。能源基建企业恩桥公司（Enbridge）已暂停一条向东输送管道的建设工作，理由是石油生产商未能作出足量供油承诺，项目收益得不到保障。

【Para.6】

The unique challenges of the oil sands provide an explanation. Investment in new sites has been virtually non-existent since the oil price crashed in 2014 as demand weakened while America's shale oil **gushed** and OPEC opened the taps. "It cannot be overstated how much that changed the industry," says Kent Fellows of the University of Calgary. Moreover, projects in the oil sands take far longer to develop than **conventional** wells. They require enormous amounts of capital that could be tied up for five to ten years before profits flow. Uncertainty over the future price of oil—and the danger that a change of government might lead to the **reinstatement** of tighter regulations—make for risky bets.

- **gush v.** /gʌʃ/ To flow out rapidly and in large quantities.

喷涌，大量流出【非考研大纲词汇】

Water gushed out from the broken pipe. 水从破裂的管道中喷涌而出。

SYN spurt, surge

- **conventional adj.** /kən'venʃənəl/ Following traditional standards; not special. 传统的，常规的【考研大纲词汇】

Most farmers still rely on conventional planting methods. 大多数农民仍然依靠传统种植方式。

SYN traditional, standard

OPP unconventional, innovative

- **reinstatement n.** /ˌriːɪn'steɪtmənt/ The act of bringing back a rule, person or policy. 恢复，复原【非考研大纲词汇】

Workers demanded the reinstatement of their former benefits. 工人们要求恢复他们原先享有的福利。

SYN restoration

OPP abolition

油砂行业面临的独特难题或许能解释这一现象。自 2014 年油价暴跌之后，几乎再无新建油砂矿区的投资。彼时石油需求走弱、美国页岩油大量增产，同时，OPEC 放开原油供应。卡尔加里大学的肯特·费洛斯（Kent Fellows）说道：“那次震荡

对整个行业造成的影响，再怎么强调都不为过。”除此以外，油砂项目的开发周期远长于传统油井，需要投入巨额资金，资金往往被套牢 5-10 年之后才能产生收益。未来油价走向不明，加之政府换届后有可能重新收紧监管，都使得这类投资风险极高。

【Para.7】

Nevertheless, at the Calgary Stampede, an annual **rodeo** festival held in July that serves as the industry's unofficial **barometer**, parties hosted by oil companies were back to their **riotous** best after **quietening** down in recent years. Their sponsorship of **rowdy** chuckwagon races broke records. That is as good a sign as any that another boom is in full swing.

- **rodeo n.** /rəʊ'deɪəʊ/ A public contest or festival of cowboy skills. 牛仔竞技表演；牛仔节【非考研大纲词汇】
Thousands of visitors come every year to watch the rodeo. 每年都有成千上万游客前来观看牛仔竞技。
- **barometer n.** /bə'rɒmɪtə(r)/ Something that indicates the state of a situation. 晴雨表，标志【考研大纲词汇】
Consumer spending is often a barometer of economic confidence. 消费支出常常是经济信心的晴雨表。
SYN indicator, signal
- **riotous adj.** /'raɪətəs/ Noisy, lively and uncontrolled. 喧闹的，狂欢的【非考研大纲词汇】

A riotous celebration was held after the team won the championship. 球队夺冠后举行了一场热闹狂欢的庆祝活动。

SYN boisterous, wild

OPP quiet, calm

- **quieten v.** /'kwaɪətən/ To become less noisy, busy or active. 平息，安静下来【非考研大纲词汇】

The excitement over the event gradually quietened down. 人们对这件事的热情渐渐冷却下来。

- **rowdy adj.** /'raʊdi/ Noisy and disorderly. 喧闹的，吵吵嚷嚷的【非考研大纲词汇】

The police separated the rowdy fans outside the stadium. 警察将体育场外喧闹的球迷隔开。

SYN noisy, boisterous

OPP peaceful, orderly

即便如此，在一年一度的卡尔加里牛仔节（7 月举办，是石油行业非官方的景气风向标）上，石油公司举办的各类派对却一扫近年来的冷清，再度变得热闹非凡。他们对气氛火爆的四轮篷车竞赛的赞助也刷新了纪录。这种迹象说明：新一轮石油繁荣正全面到来。

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➤ **今日翻译作业**

(Para. 4) Mark Carney, Canada's current prime minister, is intent on slashing the red tape that holds up projects, including streamlining environmental permitting and consultations with indigenous communities.

（下一页提供句子分析）

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 4. Mark Carney, Canada's current prime minister, is intent on slashing the red tape that holds up projects, including streamlining environmental permitting and consultations with indigenous communities. (加拿大现任总理马克·卡尼 (Mark Carney) 决心削减阻碍项目发展的繁文缛节，具体措施包括精简环境许可审批流程，以及优化与原住民社区的磋商程序。)

Mark Carney, Canada's current prime minister, is intent

主语

同位语

谓语

on slashing the red tape that holds up projects, including

宾语

定语从句

streamlining environmental permitting and consultations

状语

with indigenous communities.

句子分析：

主语：Mark Carney

同位语：Canada's current prime minister

谓语：is intent on (系表结构, intent 为表语, on 为介词)

宾语：slashing the red tape

定语从句：that holds up projects

主：that (指代 the red tape)

谓：holds up

宾：projects

现在分词短语：including streamlining environmental permitting and consultations with indigenous communities (作状语, 补充说明“削减”所涵盖的具体内容)

其中：including 后接两个并列宾语——

(1) streamlining environmental permitting (动名词短语, 意为“简化环境许可”)

(2) consultations with indigenous communities (名词短语, 意为“与土著社区的协商”, with indigenous communities 为介词短语作定语修饰 consultations)

本句主干为“Mark Carney ... is intent on slashing the red tape”。主语“Mark Carney”后接同位语“Canada's current prime minister”，点明其现任总理身份。谓语部分

“is intent on”表示“决心做某事”，后接动名词短语“slashing the red tape”作介词宾语，意为“削减繁文缛节”。该短语中的“red tape”由定语从句“that holds up projects”修饰，说明这些规章制度阻碍了项目推进。red tape表示“官僚主义的繁文缛节或程序”。句末的现在分词短语“including...”作为补充状语，具体列举了削减措施：既包括简化环境许可流程，也包括优化同原住民社区磋商的流程。整体句意强调现任总理卡尼决心通过精简审批流程和优化磋商流程来加速项目实施。

➤ 写作积累

1.(Para.1) Oil prices have jumped as the passage of tankers through the Strait of Hormuz has been **choked off**.

- ◆ **choke off** 常用被动形式 be/get choked off, 意为“被阻塞、被切断、被制止”，通常指供应、通道、活动等因外在阻碍而突然中断。

例句：Oil supplies were choked off by the blockade. 石油供应因封锁而被切断。

与之相近的短语还包括：

cut off: The electricity supply was cut off for two hours. 电力供应被切断了两个小时。

block off: Police blocked off the road due to the accident. 警察因事故封锁了道路。

2.(Para.6) “**It cannot be overstated** how much that changed the industry,” says Kent Fellows of the University of Calgary.

- ◆ **it cannot be overstated** 固定句型，意为“再怎么强调也不为过”，用于突出某事物的重要性、严重性或巨大影响。结构为形式主语 it + cannot be overstated, 真正主语由后接的 that 或 how 从句承担。

例句：It cannot be overstated how crucial this discovery is.

这一发现的重要性再怎么强调也不为过。

与之相近的短语还包括：

it cannot be overemphasized: It cannot be overemphasized that safety comes first. 安全第一再怎么强调也不为过。

it is impossible to overstate: It is impossible to overstate the impact of climate change. 气候变化的影响之大无法言尽。

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